

D633

Leadership of Curriculum Design and Instruction

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

At a middle school with a new principal and a popular robotics club, four eighth-grade science teachers each choose which units to teach. By spring, one class has studied genetics and another has not. What leadership action best addresses this?

- A. Add a genetics lesson to the robotics club.
- B. Have the team agree on essential standards all classes will teach and a schedule that makes them teachable.
- C. Let teachers keep choosing, since they know their students.
- D. Require every teacher to follow identical daily scripts.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
-----------------------------	---	-----------------------	--

2.

A standard asks students to analyze how an author's word choice shapes tone. The grade-level common assessment, written by a team that meets every Wednesday, asks students to define ten vocabulary words. The school has 850 students. What should the leader point out?

- A. The assessment asks for recall, but the standard requires analysis; it needs a task analyzing tone.
- B. The team should meet on a different day.
- C. Add twenty more words to the test.
- D. The assessment is aligned because it covers vocabulary.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
-----------------------------	---	-----------------------	--

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A standard asks students to recall multiplication facts up to 10×10 . Which assessment best matches its demand?

- A. A multistep project designing a business budget.
- B. An essay on the history of multiplication.
- C. A timed fact quiz.
- D. Any assessment, as long as it uses numbers.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
-----------------------------	---	-----------------------	--

4.

In November, benchmark data show 58% of fourth graders are below target on fractions. The school has a new playground and a 95% attendance rate. The team wants to wait for state test results in the summer before changing instruction. What should the leader recommend?

- A. Use the benchmark data now to regroup students and reteach fractions.
- B. Wait for the summer state results before acting.
- C. Celebrate the 95% attendance rate instead.
- D. Assume the data are wrong because 58% is too high.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
-----------------------------	---	-----------------------	---

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A leader has last year's end-of-year state results. What is their best use?

- A. Grade individual teachers on a single score.
- B. Adjust tomorrow's lessons for last year's students.
- C. Evaluate programs and set goals and priorities for the coming year.
- D. Replace all formative assessment.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
-----------------------------	---	-----------------------	---

6.

A PLC in a school with a new library spends its meetings planning field trips and discussing the copier. Members say they enjoy the time together. Which agenda change best aligns the team with PLC purpose?

- A. Focus on what students should learn, how the team will know, and how to respond when students do or do not learn.
- B. Meet less often.
- C. Add library scheduling to the agenda.
- D. Keep the agenda, since members enjoy it.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
-----------------------------	---	-----------------------	---

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team finds that 20% of students already mastered the unit before it began. Which PLC question does this address?

- A.** What do we want students to learn?
- B.** How will we respond when students do not learn?
- C.** How will we know when they have learned it?
- D.** How will we extend learning for students who are already proficient?

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A principal leads a team on learning walks through 15 classrooms, looking at the level of student questioning. She is known for her detailed notes and has a new tablet. What is the best use of the data?

- A.** Use the tablet to post notes on social media.
- B.** Rank the 15 teachers.
- C.** Share school-wide patterns in student questioning and plan professional learning around them.
- D.** Put each teacher's notes in their evaluation file.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A new principal at a school with a strong music program notices that teachers rarely share struggles in meetings. The previous principal often promised resources that never arrived. The school has 60 staff members. What should the principal do first to build trust?

- A.** Tell staff they must trust her because she is the principal.
- B.** Promise many new resources right away.
- C.** Announce a bold new program to show energy.
- D.** Make small, specific commitments and visibly follow through while listening to staff concerns.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

At a school known for its garden program, a team proposes that students below grade level in reading permanently use easier texts in social studies. The team has worked together for eight years. What response reflects high expectations?

- A.** Approve the proposal, since the team is experienced.
- B.** Require grade-level texts with no support.
- C.** Remove social studies for those students.
- D.** Keep grade-level texts and add supports like read-alouds, vocabulary previews, and small-group help.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

Math proficiency rose from 40% to 50% this year at a school that recently switched lunch vendors. The school newsletter, which goes to 1,200 families, says “proficiency rose 10%.” What is the more accurate statement?

- A.** Proficiency rose 10% relative to last year.
- B.** Proficiency rose 10 percentage points, a 25% relative increase.
- C.** Proficiency rose 20%.
- D.** Proficiency rose 50%.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A school’s proficiency rate was 60% and rose by 15% in relative terms. What is the new rate?

- A.** 51%
- B.** 69%
- C.** 15%
- D.** 75%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

At a middle school ~~with a new principal and a popular robotics club~~, four eighth-grade science teachers each choose which units to teach. By spring, one class has studied genetics and another has not. What leadership action best addresses this?

Target word: fix the inconsistency **Decides:** Essential content varies by teacher.

A	Camouflage	An irrelevant fix outside the course.
B	Correct	Creates a guaranteed and viable curriculum.
C	Dropped element	Leaves the guarantee missing.
D	Absolute language	Guaranteed essentials do not require scripts.

2. Answer A Concept 2

A standard asks students to analyze how an author's word choice shapes tone. The grade-level common assessment, ~~written by a team that meets every Wednesday~~, asks students to define ten vocabulary words. ~~The school has 850 students~~. What should the leader point out?

Target word: alignment issue **Decides:** The test demands lower thinking than the standard.

A	Correct	Cognitive demand must match.
B	Camouflage	Schedule is irrelevant.
C	Dropped element	More recall still misses analysis.
D	Confusion set	Same topic is not the same rigor.

3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

A standard asks students to recall multiplication facts up to 10×10 . Which assessment best matches its demand?

Target word: reverse: match assessment to a recall standard **Decides:** The standard is recall-level.

A	Inverted operation	Too high a demand for a recall standard.
B	Adjacent category	Different content and skill.
C	Correct	Matches a recall standard.
D	Absolute language	Topic match alone is not alignment.

4. Answer A Concept 3

In November, benchmark data show 58% of fourth graders are below target on fractions. ~~The school has a new playground and a 95% attendance rate~~. The team wants to wait for state test results in the summer before changing instruction. What should the leader recommend?

Target word: timely use of data **Decides:** Benchmark data arrive while teaching is ongoing.

A	Correct	Interim data are for adjusting current instruction.
B	Inverted operation	Summative data come too late for this year's students.
C	Camouflage	Attendance does not address the fraction gap.
D	Absolute language	Dismisses evidence without cause.

5. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

A leader has last year's end-of-year state results. What is their best use?

Target word: reverse: role of summative data **Decides:** Summative results inform program and planning decisions.

A	Absolute language	One score is not a sound basis for rating teachers.
B	Inverted operation	Those students have moved on; that is a formative use.
C	Correct	Summative data judge results and guide planning.
D	Adjacent category	Summative data cannot guide daily instruction.

6. Answer A Concept 4

~~A PLC in a school with a new library~~ spends its meetings planning field trips and discussing the copier. ~~Members say they enjoy the time together.~~ Which agenda change best aligns the team with PLC purpose?

Target word: refocus PLC time **Decides:** Meetings ignore learning questions.

A	Correct	The four PLC questions drive the work.
B	Dropped element	Does not refocus the work.
C	Adjacent category	Still logistics.
D	Camouflage	Enjoyment is not the purpose.

7. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

A team finds that 20% of students already mastered the unit before it began. Which PLC question does this address?

Target word: classify the question **Decides:** Students who already know it.

A	Adjacent category	That defines the target, not extension.
B	Inverted operation	That is about intervention.
C	Confusion set	Assessment, not the response.
D	Correct	The fourth question is about extension.

8. Answer C Concept 5

A principal leads a team on learning walks through 15 classrooms, looking at the level of student questioning. ~~She is known for her detailed notes and has a new tablet.~~ What is the best use of the data?

Target word: purpose of walkthroughs **Decides:** Walks look for school-wide patterns.

A	Camouflage	Irrelevant and inappropriate.
B	Adjacent category	Ranking is evaluation, not pattern finding.
C	Correct	Walkthroughs guide collective support.
D	Inverted operation	Turns a non-evaluative walk into rating.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A new principal at a school ~~with a strong music program~~ notices that teachers rarely share struggles in meetings. The previous principal often promised resources that never arrived. ~~The school has 60 staff members.~~ What should the principal do first to build trust?

Target word: build relational trust **Decides:** Broken commitments damaged trust.

A	Absolute language	Authority does not create trust.
B	Inverted operation	Repeats the pattern that broke trust.
C	Adjacent category	A program does not rebuild trust.
D	Correct	Integrity and personal regard rebuild trust.

10. Answer D Concept 7

At a school ~~known for its garden program~~, a team proposes that students below grade level in reading permanently use easier texts in social studies. ~~The team has worked together for eight years.~~ What response reflects high expectations?

Target word: high expectations with support **Decides:** The proposal lowers the bar.

A	Camouflage	Experience does not justify lower expectations.
B	Dropped element	High bar without the support part.
C	Inverted operation	Removes access entirely.
D	Correct	Keeps rigor while adding support.

11. Answer B Concept 8

Math proficiency rose from 40% to 50% this year at a school ~~that recently switched lunch vendors~~. The school newsletter, ~~which goes to 1,200 families~~, says “proficiency rose 10%.” What is the more accurate statement?

Target word: points vs. percent **Decides:** 40% to 50%.

A	Confusion set	The relative increase is 25%.
B	Correct	$50 - 40 = 10$ points; $10/40 = 25\%$.
C	Inverted operation	Divides by the new rate (10/50) instead of the old.
D	Wrong stem number	That is the new rate, not the change.

12. Answer B Concept 8 • transfer

A school’s proficiency rate was 60% and rose by 15% in relative terms. What is the new rate?

Target word: solve for the new rate **Decides:** $\text{New} = 60 \times 1.15$.

A	Inverted operation	Decreases instead of increases.
B	Correct	$60 \times 1.15 = 69$.
C	Wrong stem number	The change, not the rate.
D	Confusion set	Adds 15 percentage points instead of 15% of 60.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Guaranteed and viable curriculum	Every student gets the same essential content no matter which teacher they have (guaranteed), and there is enough time to teach it (viable).	Letting each teacher decide what essentials to cover.	Students in the same course learning different essentials.
2	Assessment matched to standard rigor	In a coherent system, assessments demand the same thinking level as the standards and instruction.	Checking only that the topic matches, not the cognitive demand.	A standard that says analyze with a test that asks for recall.
3	Using formative vs. summative data	Formative and interim data guide changes while instruction is still underway; summative data judge results at the end and inform next year's planning.	Waiting for end-of-year results to adjust current instruction.	When the data arrive relative to the teaching.
4	The four PLC questions	Teams ask: What should students learn? How will we know? What if they don't? What if they already do?	Using PLC time for logistics or venting.	A team meeting agenda to evaluate.
5	Non-evaluative walkthroughs	Instructional rounds and learning walks look for school-wide patterns to guide support, not to rate individual teachers.	Using walkthrough notes as individual evaluations.	A leader collecting classroom data for improvement.
6	Relational trust	Trust rests on respect, personal regard, competence, and integrity; leaders build it by keeping commitments and involving staff.	Assuming authority or a new program creates trust.	Staff hesitant to share problems with a leader.
7	High expectations with support	Keep rigorous goals for all students and add scaffolds and time rather than lowering the bar.	Watering down content for struggling students.	A proposal to give some students easier work permanently.
8	Percentage points vs. percent change	A move from 40% to 50% proficient is a 10-percentage-point gain but a 25% relative increase.	Mixing the two when reporting results.	Two proficiency rates and a question about the size of the change.

Course scope (public description): Leadership of Curriculum Design and Instruction prepares candidates to evaluate and implement curricular programs and instructional methods observed at the school level. Candidates focus on the knowledge and skills needed to develop, align, and implement cohesive systems of curriculum, instruction, and assessment. Importance is placed on responding to student needs, embodying high expectations for student learning, aligning with academic and non-academic standards within and across grade levels, and promoting students' academic and non-academic success and social and emotional well-being. This course also explores the use of data from formative and summative assessments to make recommendations to improve instruction and promote student learning and well-being. Candidates are prepared to build a professional culture of trust and collaboration to ensure they are able to work with school personnel in creating curricular programs and instructional methods that are engaging, challenging, and relevant to student needs, experiences, and interests. This course is designed to be taken after successful completion of D632: Cultural Competency and

Social-Emotional Learning.